

states WEST BENGAL

THE MARXIST HOR

SUBIR HALDER



Nandigram has become the byword for state-sponsored terror in Indian communism's trophy state. The reformist chief minister loses his sheen as he shows no sense of remorse.

■ **By Swagata Sen and Satarupa Bhattacharjya**

Nobody can beat the Indian Marxist in sub-rural horror. And no dialectical triangulations by the suave apparatchiks at AKG Bhavan in Delhi can be a distraction from the bloodlust in the countryside, where the armed struggle never ends. On Diwali night in

Nandigram—which would go down in the hoary history of Indian communism as the site where the Bengal CPI(M) unravell'd itself—the “red army” abandoned firecrackers and set the enemy houses on fire in celebration. Official statistics—11 dead and more than a hundred wounded in a week—may not reveal the full magnitude of the Marxist bestiality, but fear and the total collapse of civic authority do.

On November 11, when CPI(M) “liberated” the villages that were being controlled by the Trinamool Congress (TC)-led Bhoomi Uchhed Pratirodh Committee (BUPC)—save land committee—in Nandigram, it was only another chapter in the politics of vendetta that CPI(M) has been practising to bloody perfection for the past many years. In the biggest administrative failure of the West Bengal Government in recent